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Justin Narciso • NYC Energy Engineering Firm • July 2026

Post 1 | Project Case Study: Heat Pump Retrofit

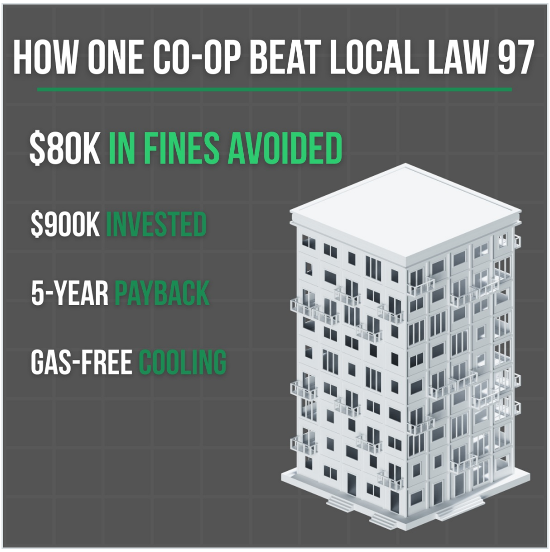
In the Upper East Side, a co-op had been cooling their building the same way for decades, leaving them facing $80,000 in Local Law 97 penalties.

The building's cooling system was burning natural gas all summer to run outdated equipment. Inefficient, costly, and on the wrong side of NYC's Local Law 97, hitting buildings like this one with hefty fines.

Led by the firm's founder, the team replaced the old cooling system with heat pump technology. Six modular units installed through a doorway, bolted together on-site. The 1960s building simply didn't have the space for anything bigger, so they worked with what they had. A 200-kilowatt electrical upgrade was negotiated with Con Edison, with custom switchgear manufactured and approved by the Department of Buildings.

The board spent $900,000, money they'll earn back in five years. Resulting in one less building burning fossil fuels in Manhattan, carbon penalties avoided, and a building running a cleaner, more efficient system that saves money for everyone.

#LocalLaw97 #HeatPumps #Electrification #NYCBuildings



VISUAL CONCEPT

A stat graphic that leads with the outcome instead of the equipment, with four short lines built to read at feed-scroll size. The charcoal and green palette starts a consistent brand system that carries across all three posts.

PROCESS & AI

I wanted this to read like a story, not a press release, so I opened on the $80,000 fine, walked through the real obstacles, and closed on the five-year payback. I used AI to pull the key facts out of the source article, then did the storytelling myself and ran a tone check to cut anything that sounded salesy. The detail AI kept skipping past, the pumps having to fit through a doorway, was the most memorable part of the whole story, so I made sure it stayed in.

Post 2 | Educational: NYC Benchmarking Laws (LL84/133)

If you own a building in NYC that's over 25,000 square feet, the city requires you to report its energy and water use every year. Here's how it works.

The requirement comes from Local Law 84/133, also known as the NYC Benchmarking Laws. Owners report their property's annual energy and water consumption through ENERGY STAR Portfolio Manager, a free tool from the Environmental Protection Agency that compares your building's performance against similar buildings.

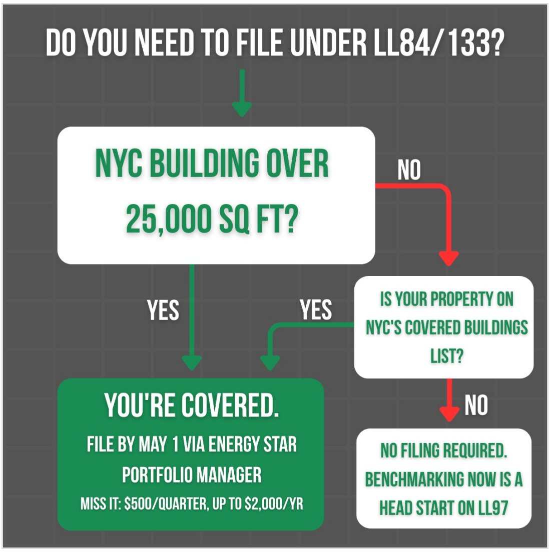
The deadline is May 1st each year. After that, violations accrue at $500 per quarter, up to $2,000 annually.

The submission includes details like gross floor area, space usage types, and building-wide energy and water consumption. Because accuracy matters and errors may result in penalties, many owners work with a Professional Engineer to handle the filing.

The city requires this because benchmarking gives owners a clear picture of how their building actually uses energy. That data becomes the starting point for spotting inefficiencies, planning upgrades, and staying ahead of stricter laws down the road, such as Local Law 97's carbon emissions limits.

If you're unsure whether your building is covered, NYC publishes a Covered Buildings List each year.

#LocalLaw84 #Benchmarking #NYCBuildings #EnergyEfficiency



VISUAL CONCEPT

A decision tree, because the audience's first question about any law is "does this apply to me?" The visual answers it in seconds, and both yes paths merge into one green outcome so the layout itself shows that most paths lead to filing.

PROCESS & AI

The goal was to make a tedious compliance topic clear in one read. I first asked AI to explain the law like I was a board member with no technical background, then had it stress-test my structure, and it suggested opening with the reader's situation instead of the name of the law, which I adopted. The facts came from the firm's own webpage rather than AI, since AI gets legal details like penalty amounts wrong. I moved the deadline and penalties up front and cut a generic "contact us" close in favor of pointing readers to the Covered Buildings List.

Post 3 | Awareness: National Cut Your Energy Costs Day

Today is National Cut Your Energy Costs Day. Most of the advice out there focuses on homeowners, sealing your windows, switching to LEDs, and so on. But things change when you're responsible for an entire building.

For boards, owners, and property managers, cutting energy costs looks different.

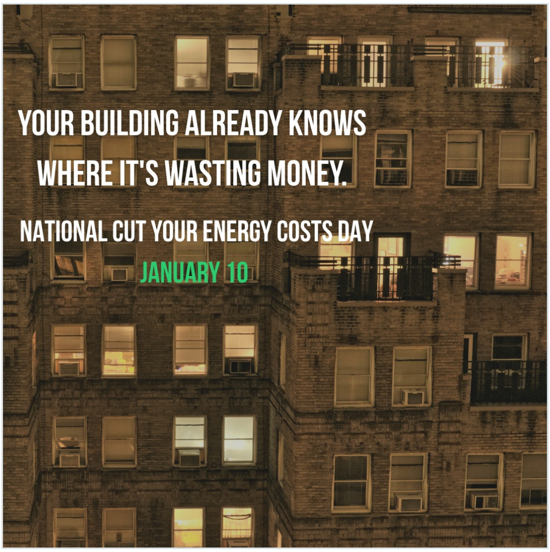
Everything begins with gathering data. Benchmarking numbers show where a building is losing money, yet most owners file them every year and never go beyond that.

Auditing before upgrading prevents expensive mistakes, because new equipment only pays off when you know what's actually wrong.

And knowing what you don't have to pay for matters too. Between utility rebates, tax incentives, and financing programs, buildings tend to leave significant amounts of money on the table.

So how does a building actually start solving energy waste? It starts with understanding your building, not just upgrading it.

#CutYourEnergyCostsDay #EnergyEfficiency #NYCBuildings #BuildingPerformance



VISUAL CONCEPT

A nighttime photo of a NYC apartment building, because every lit window and window AC unit literally shows the energy use the post is about. The audience of building owners sees their own world at eye level instead of a generic lightbulb-and-leaves energy visual.

PROCESS & AI

I wanted to join the awareness day without posting the generic "turn off your lights" tips every company runs. I had AI brainstorm a batch of angles, and most were exactly those homeowner cliches, which made me realize the homeowner-versus-building contrast should be the hook itself. So the thing AI got wrong became the whole angle, once I filtered it down to what actually fits a building-owner audience.